A coastal fish cooperative is losing income because its storage rooms warm overnight. The members have proposed purchasing another delivery truck, yet dispatch records show that vehicles spend their mornings waiting beside unreliable refrigeration equipment. Expanding transport before stabilizing storage would increase idle capacity rather than preserve more fish. The first investment should therefore address the temperature failure at the landing site. This is a synthetic business case; the quantities below are illustrative rather than observations from a real cooperative.

The pilot would assign two members to inspect seals and clean condenser coils every evening. A paper log would record room temperature at closing and opening. Repairs would be funded from a ring fenced maintenance reserve instead of an additional vehicle loan. Members would compare spoilage during similar landing volumes, since a small catch can make a weak process appear successful. If repair parts cannot arrive promptly, insulated crates provide a temporary buffer without committing the group to a new vehicle.

The harbor cooperative should repair its cold storage before buying another delivery truck. Fish currently spoil while drivers wait for ice. A shared maintenance schedule and insulated crates would protect the catch. We would measure discarded kilograms each morning and pause expansion until spoilage falls for four consecutive weeks.

The decision rule should use the fraction of landed fish discarded, not revenue alone, because auction prices change with weather and seasonal supply. Every participating vessel would receive the same access to crates during the trial. A rotating committee would publish aggregate totals without disclosing individual earnings. A four week reduction in waste would justify extending the maintenance arrangement, while unstable temperatures would trigger a specialist inspection. The cooperative should stop the pilot if contamination incidents increase, even if transport margins improve. These checks distinguish the operational claim from a generic recommendation to expand distribution.